

Bennett Smolen

Arlington, VA 22201 | (267) 414-7840 | bennett.smolen1@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** Java, Python, C, Verilog, Spring Boot, Spring WebFlux, REST APIs, GraphQL
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, EKS, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Spinnaker, Rancher, Jenkins, Apigee
- **Data & Messaging:** PostgreSQL, Kafka, ActiveMQ, WebSocket
- **Security, Testing & Observability:** OAuth2, PingFed, HashiCorp Vault, JUnit, Cucumber, Postman, Kibana, Kiali, Ctrl-M

EXPERIENCE

Freddie Mac

McLean, VA

Software Engineer II

July 2023 - Current

- Led development of a mainframe modernization initiative, designing an Apigee API gateway integration layer to bridge a legacy monolith with microservice architecture on AWS, enabling annual cost savings of \$2M+ from retiring legacy systems
- Built a Spring Boot virtualization service on Kubernetes that eliminated cross team dependencies for seven applications, cutting test data setup time from hours to minutes, and enabling my team to meet 90% automation coverage requirement a quarter ahead of schedule
- Led adoption of GraphQL and Kafka across three applications, creating a shared Java library that standardized client configuration, cutting onboarding time for new applications from two weeks to three days
- Redesigned existing REST API integrations to leverage WebSockets and Spring WebFlux, enabling non-blocking, event-driven processing and real-time data streaming, significantly reducing latency and processing time on 300k+ events/hour
- Mentored a new hire on the team's stack and codebase architecture, accelerating their ramp-up to independently shipping production code and making architectural decisions

Software Engineer I

July 2022 - July 2023

- Built and deployed Spring Boot microservices on Kubernetes hosted on AWS EC2 to automate mortgage insurance claims and billing workflows via REST API integrations with insurance providers, supporting \$100M+ in annual recoveries
- Authored SQL scripts against PostgreSQL to identify and recover \$200k+ in proceeds missed due to data pipeline failures
- Ensured system reliability through JUnit/Cucumber test suites, Ctrl-M job scheduling, and observability via Rancher, Kibana, and Kiali, maintaining 99.99% uptime across production services

UKG

Remote

Software Engineer Intern

Sep 2021 - Nov 2021

- Developed and deployed seamless MuleSoft integrations for scalable data transfer between clients and insurance carriers, optimizing latency and data accuracy across multiple enterprise applications
- Engineered advanced DataWeave scripts to standardize and automate data formatting, enabling faster client onboarding and reducing manual adjustments by 40%
- Led a cross-functional team to build a React/Firebase MVP ("Tinder for Clothes") in 48 hours, winning an internal hackathon

Penn State

State College, PA

Head TA, Computer Engineering

Jan 2020- May 2021

- Authored course content, answer keys, and drove processes to grade homework and exams for 380+ students
- Led labs for students and maintained office hours to assist with homework questions and studying
- Built an AutoHotkey/Python program to automate the totaling of exam scores, reducing required time by 80%

Jitsik

Philadelphia, PA

Software Engineer Intern

June 2019- Aug 2019

- Developed Unity/C# features for VR-based driver training simulations, including autonomous driving scenarios and picture-in-picture mirror functionality
- Improved application performance through debugging and optimization efforts, increasing frame rates by 15%

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University

State College, PA

B.S. Computer Science | Minors in Mathematics & Business

May 2022

Activities: IEEE, ACM, Poker Club, Jiu-Jitsu Club